

NAVIGATOR KIDS: SPACE PUP MISSION

A Manual for High-Speed Brains

MISSION LOG:

Cadet Name: _____

Launch Date: _____

IDENTIFY YOUR CREW ROLE:

(Check all that apply to your Super Brain)

☐ **The Idea Engine:** My brain moves faster than a rocket.

☐ **The Deep Diver:** When I like a topic, I learn *everything* about it.

☐ **The Sensor:** I notice sounds and lights that others miss.

☐ **The Dreamer:** I have big, amazing plans in my head.

CURRENT STATUS:

Sometimes, having a Super Brain feels like having a rocket engine with no steering wheel. Today, we are going to build your **Mission Control Center**.

Are you ready?

☐ YES ☐ ROGER THAT!

Page 2: The Story – The Jammed Rocket

Meet Cosmo.

Cosmo is a Space Pup with a very special brain. He is smart, funny, and full of energy. But Cosmo has a problem.

Sometimes, Cosmo has **SO MANY** things to do—chase comets, fix the ship, eat moon cheese—that his brain gets a "Traffic Jam."

He wants to start, but his paws feel stuck to the floor. The Rocket Engine is roaring, but the ship won't move!

This is called "Task Paralysis."

It doesn't mean you are lazy. It means your brain has too much fuel and doesn't know where to pour it!

YOUR TURN:

Draw what your brain looks like when it feels "Stuck." Is it a tangled knot? A spinning storm? A traffic jam?

Page 3: Launch Skill #1 – Mission Target

THE PROBLEM:

Your brain sees EVERYTHING at once. Cleaning your room isn't one job; your brain sees 100 toys, 5 shirts, and a dirty sock. It's too much!

THE SOLUTION:

We need to pick **ONE** Mission Target.

Activity: The Target Lock

Below is a list of things to do. Your job is to ignore the rest and coloring in the **Bullseye** next to just ONE task.

Mission List:

- () Clean the *entire* bedroom.
- () Finish *all* the math homework.
- () Put away the laundry.

MY CHOSEN TARGET:

Write the ONE thing you picked here:

Color the Target:

(Color the center circle red to "Lock On" to your mission!)

[(((•)))]

Rule: You cannot worry about the other tasks until this ONE target is hit.

Page 4: Launch Skill #2 – The Tiny First Step

THE PROBLEM:

Even one target can feel heavy. "Do Homework" feels like lifting a space rock.

THE SOLUTION:

Make the first step so tiny, it's silly. If the step is too big, the rocket won't launch. We need a **Micro-Step**.

Let's Practice:

Look at the Big Mission. Break it down until you find the Micro-Step.

BIG MISSION: Write a Book Report.

- **Medium Step:** Read the book. (Still too big!)
- **Small Step:** Get the paper. (Better...)
- **Micro-Step:** *Touch the pencil.* (PERFECT!)

Your Turn:

Think of a job you hate doing. Break it down!

1. **Big Mission:** _____

2. **Medium Step:** _____

3. **MICRO-STEP:** _____

(Hint: It should be something you can do in 10 seconds!)

Page 5: Launch Skill #3 – 3-2-1 Blastoff!

THE PROBLEM:

Sometimes you know *what* to do, but your body just won't move. You are sitting on the couch, telling yourself "Get up," but you stay seated.

THE SOLUTION:

Your brain needs a **Launch Signal**. Astronauts don't just guess when to launch; they use a countdown.

The Strategy:

1. Sit comfortably.
2. Take a deep breath.
3. Say "3... 2... 1..." out loud.
4. When you say **BLASTOFF**, you *must* move your body. Even if it's just to stand up.

Activity: The Launch Button

Color the button below RED. When you need to start a hard task, physically press this button on the paper and start your countdown.



Practice Run:

Right now, countdown from 3. When you hit Blastoff, clap your hands as loud as you can!

Page 6: Launch Skill #4 – Checkpoint Stars

THE PROBLEM:

Deep space is dark and endless. If you can't see the finish line, your brain runs out of gas.

THE SOLUTION:

Don't fly to Mars in one go. Fly to the Moon, then to the Space Station, *then* to Mars. These are **Checkpoints**.

Activity: Map Your Course

Take a task (like "Getting Ready for School") and draw 3 Stars to connect the dots.

START (Bed) FINISH (School)

Star 1: _____

(Example: Brush Teeth)

Star 2: _____

(Example: Clothes On)

Star 3: _____

(Example: Shoes On)

Every time you hit a star, give yourself a mental "Ding!" sound effect. You earned dopamine!

Page 7: The Science – Mission Control

Why is this so hard?

Inside your forehead is a part of the brain called the **Prefrontal Cortex**. Let's call it **Mission Control**.

The Job of Mission Control:

1. Planning routes.
2. Ignoring distractions (like space junk).
3. Starting the engines.

The Super-Brain Glitch:

Because you are smart/creative/sensitive, your brain generates **EXTRA** rocket fuel (thoughts and ideas).

Sometimes, Mission Control gets overwhelmed by all the data coming in. It's like 100 people talking on the radio at once!

How the Tools Help:

- **Mission Target:** Tells the radio to listen to only one person.
- **Countdown:** Forces the engines to ignite manually.
- **Checkpoints:** Gives Mission Control a map so it doesn't get lost.

You aren't broken. You just have a high-performance engine that needs a skilled pilot!

Page 8: Scenario Challenge

Situation:

Cosmo needs to clean his spaceship (room). It is a disaster! There are space-toys everywhere, dirty space-suits on the floor, and wrappers on the desk. Cosmo is lying on his bed staring at the ceiling, feeling frozen.

What should Cosmo do?

Option A: Wait until his mom yells at him.

Option B: Try to clean everything at once by running in circles.

Option C: Use the Launch Codes.

Let's help Cosmo use Option C!

1. **Target:** He ignores the clothes and wrappers. He focuses **ONLY** on the **Toys**.
2. **Tiny Step:** He doesn't pick up all the toys. He picks up **ONE** red block.
3. **Blastoff:** He counts **3-2-1** and throws the block in the bin.

Result:

Once the first block is in the bin, his engine is running! Now it's easy to pick up the second one.

Draw a medal for Cosmo here:

Page 9: Parent & Crew Chief Guide

The Science of "Task Initiation"

For neurodivergent children (ADHD, 2e, Autism), the struggle often isn't *ability*; it's **activation**.

1. Executive Function (EF) Fatigue:

Your child's brain is processing more sensory and cognitive input than average. By the time they need to "clean their room," their EF fuel tank might be empty. The tools in this book reduce the "fuel cost" of starting.

2. The "Wall of Awful":

Brendan Mahan (ADHD expert) describes the emotional barrier to starting tasks as the "Wall of Awful." Every time a child fails to start, a brick of shame is added to the wall.

- **Goal:** Don't smash the wall. Build a door.
- **The Door:** The *Tiny First Step*. It lowers the threshold of entry so low that failure is impossible.

3. Dopamine and Checkpoints:

Neurotypical brains get a dopamine reward when they *finish* a task. ADHD/2e brains often don't. They need rewards *during* the task. "Checkpoint Stars" provide immediate visual feedback, giving the brain the chemical fuel to keep going.

Quick Script for Parents:

- Instead of: "Go clean your room."
- Try: "Space Cadet, what is your *Mission Target*? Just the legos? Great. What is the *tiniest* step to start that?"

| 🎯 MISSION TARGET | 🦶 TINY FIRST STEP | | | | Rule: I
can only do | Is the step too big? | | ONE thing at a time.

Make it smaller.	Make it sillier.
<i>Ignore the rest.</i>	<i>Just touch the pencil.</i>

 3-2-1 BLASTOFF |  CHECKPOINT STARS ||||| 1.
Sit still. | Don't look at the mountain. | | 2. Deep breath. |
Look at the next rock. | | 3. Count down. | | | ACTION! |
One star at a time. |



MISSION ACCOMPLISHED



This certifies that

Has mastered the Launch Codes and is now a

CAPTAIN OF ACTION

"I can do hard things, one tiny step at a time."

Signed: _____ (Chief of Command)